

SSD-TV-722 could manage 84, while the remaining could do 82. But as we've already mentioned, this is not a bad figure at all.

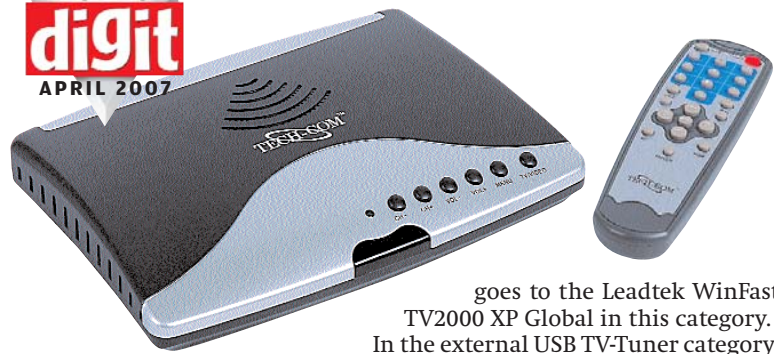
Nothing came even close to the AVerMedia AVerTV Box7 as far as image quality goes. Even at the same resolution, the Tech-Com SSD-TV-722 and the Zebronics lagged in this respect. The Tech-Com SSD-TV-715, which has a resolution of 640 x 480, was way behind the former three, owing to its much lower resolution.

Conclusion

Even with the same chipsets, we saw that many TV-Tuners performed differently and exhibited variation in image quality. Therefore, it is not only the chipset that matters, but also the PCB design and the PVR. Most TV-Tuner manufacturers go by the reference board design, but an innovative few dare to invest in R&D and make design improvements. It is therefore fair that such manufacturers charge a premium for their products.

In the internal PCI category, the Leadtek WinFast TV-Tuners stole the show. These have all the features one would expect from a TV-Tuner, and they are also compatible with Windows XP MCE and Vista. The PVR2000 is the only tuner with an MPEG-2 encoder chip, and comes well-endowed with a useful software bundle. Both these cards excelled in performance as well as features, and come with all the necessary cables. The *Digit Best Buy Gold* therefore goes to Leadtek WinFast PVR2000, while the *Digit Best Buy Silver*

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Tech-Com SSD-TV-722
Good Value For Your Money

goes to the Leadtek WinFast TV2000 XP Global in this category.

In the external USB TV-Tuner category, the Leadtek WinFast PalmTop TV exhibited performance par excellence. It is the lone card with features such as hardware MPEG-2 encoding, PIP with two channels simultaneously, and MCE compatibility. At Rs 3,900, this is without hesitation the winner of the *Digit Best Buy Gold* in this category.

The Compro VideoMate Action Pro has good video quality—as good as the Gold winner—and with it comes the most extensive and useful software and cable bundle. Priced just right at Rs 3,395, this is rightfully awarded the *Digit Best Buy Silver*.

Nothing came close to the AVerMedia AVerTV Box7 in terms of performance, and it rode ahead of the rest with the best channel detection score and video quality at a high resolution of 1280 x 1024. It has all types of connectors, enabling you to connect any AV source to

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